🏛 Lingua Latina — Pronuntiatio Classica

> *Latin pronunciation guide for the Classical system (1st c. BC – 2nd c. AD). This is the system used in all your IPA transcriptions.*

I. The Five Iron Rules

These five rules cover **90% of all pronunciation confusion**. Burn them in.

Rule	Letter	Always sounds like	Never sounds like
1	**C**	/k/ — Slovenian *k*	/s/, /ts/, /tʃ/ (č)
2	**G**	/g/ — Slovenian *g* in *gora*	/dʒ/ (đ), /ʒ/, /j/
3	**TI**	/ti/ — two separate sounds	/tsi/, /tʃi/ (či)
4	**V**	/w/ — English *w* in *water*	/v/ (Slovenian *v*)
5	**QU**	/kw/ — English *qu* in *queen*	/ku/, /kv/, /k/

No exceptions. No matter what vowel follows. C before E is still /k/. G before I is still /g/.

II. Consonant Reference

Letter	IPA	Sounds like	Notes
B	/b/	Slovenian *b*	voiced stop
C	/k/	Slovenian *k*	**always** /k/
D	/d/	Slovenian *d*	dental, tongue touches teeth
F	/f/	Slovenian *f*	lower lip to upper teeth
G	/g/	Slovenian *g*	**always** /g/ hard
H	/h/	English *h*	soft breath. Not silent (unlike some Italian Latin)
K	/k/	Slovenian *k*	rare letter, same as C
L	/l/	Slovenian *l*	clear, not velar/dark
M	/m/	Slovenian *m*	at end of word: barely sounded, nasal hum
N	/n/	Slovenian *n*	dental, tongue touches teeth
P	/p/	Slovenian *p*	slight aspiration (tiny puff of air)
Q	/kʷ/	/k/ + /w/ together	**always** with U → QU = /kw/
R	/r/	Slovenian *r*	trilled/rolled, never swallowed
S	/s/	Slovenian *s*	always voiceless /s/, never /z/
T	/t/	Slovenian *t*	dental, no palatalization before i
V	/w/	English *w*	**Classical V = /w/**, not /v/
X	/ks/	/k/ + /s/	two sounds together
Z	/dz/	/d/ + /z/	rare, only in Greek loanwords

Consonant clusters

Cluster	IPA	Sounds like	Example
SC	/sk/	/s/ + /k/	*nascitur* → NAS-ki-tur
ST	/st/	/s/ + /t/	*est* → est
SP	/sp/	/s/ + /p/	*spirat* → SPI-rat
TR	/tr/	/t/ + /r/	*transit* → TRAN-sit
QU	/kw/	/k/ + /w/	*loquitur* → LO-kwi-tur
NGU	/ŋgw/	nasal /n/ + /g/ + /w/	*sanguis* → SAN-gwis
BR	/br/	/b/ + /r/	*umbra* → UM-bra

III. Vowel Reference

Letter	Short	Long	Marked	Sounds like (short)	Sounds like (long)
A	/a/	/aː/	ā	Slovenian *a* in *dan*	same, held longer
E	/ɛ/	/eː/	ē	Slovenian *e* in *pet* (open)	Slovenian *e* in *med* (closed), held
I	/i/	/iː/	ī	Slovenian *i* in *ni*	same, held longer
O	/ɔ/	/oː/	ō	Slovenian *o* but more open	same, held longer
U	/u/	/uː/	ū	Slovenian *u* in *ura*	same, held longer
Y	/y/	/yː/	—	German *ü*, French *u*	same, held longer (Greek loanwords)

Diphthongs (two vowels, one glide)

Diphthong	IPA	Sounds like	Example
AE	/ae̯/	English *ai* in "aisle"	*animae* → A-ni-mai
AU	/au̯/	English *ou* in "house"	*aurum* → AU-rum
OE	/oe̯/	English *oi* in "oil"	*poena* → POE-na
EU	/eu̯/	/e/ + /u/ glide	*seu* → seu
UI	/ui̯/	/u/ + /i/ glide	*huic* → huic (rare)

IV. Stress Rules

Latin stress is **predictable**. Three rules:

1. **Two-syllable words:** stress the **first** — always.
    - *dolor* → **DO**-lor
    - *fugit* → **FU**-git
    - *corpus* → **KOR**-pus
2. **Three+ syllable words:** stress the **penultimate** (second-to-last) **IF it is long**.
    - *ve-ri-ta-tis* → we-ri-**TAA**-tis (the /aː/ is long)

- *sa-pi-en-ti-ae* → sa-pi-**EN**-ti-ai (the /ɛ/ in *en* is long by position)

3. **If the penultimate is short:** stress the **antepenultimate** (third-to-last).
   - *o-ri-go* → o-**RI**-go (the /i/ is short)
   - *om-nis* → **OM**-nis
   - *vo-cis* → **WO**-kis

In practice: most of your sentences stress the penultimate or antepenultimate. The IPA marks stress with ˈ before the stressed syllable.

V. Classical vs. Church Latin — Quick Comparison

Feature	Classical (yours)	Church Latin (NOT yours)
C before E/I	/k/ (KAI-sar)	/tʃ/ (CHAI-sar)
G before E/I	/g/ (hard)	/dʒ/ (ɖ, like "gem")
TI + vowel	/ti/ (separate)	/tsi/ or /tʃi/
V	/w/	/v/
AE	/ae̯/ (ai-sound)	/ɛ/ (just open e)
H	/h/ (breathed)	silent
GN	/gn/ (two sounds)	/ɲ/ (like Spanish ñ)

If you hear someone say "CHEE-che-ro" for Cicero — that's Church Latin. Your Cicero is "KI-ke-ro."

VI. All Your Sentences — Full Phonetic Reading

Each sentence is given in three lines:

1. **Latin** (original)
2. **IPA** (Classical pronunciation)
3. **Read as** (syllable-by-syllable, stress in CAPS)

🌊 Fluvia I — De Silentio et Esse

1. Silentium non est absentia soni, sed origo omnis vocis.

IPA: /siˈlɛn.ti.um nɔn ɛst abˈsɛn.ti.a ˈsɔ.ni sɛd oˈri.go ˈom.nis ˈwo.kis/

Read: si-LEN-ti-um NON est ab-SEN-ti-a SO-ni sed o-RI-go OM-nis WO-kis

Word	IPA	Key traps
Silentium	/siˈlɛn.ti.um/	TI = /ti/, not /tsi/
absentia	/abˈsɛn.ti.a/	TI = /ti/ again
soni	/ˈsɔ.ni/	/ɔ/ is open, not rounded
origo	/oˈri.go/	**G = /g/** hard

Word	IPA	Key traps
vocis	/ˈwo.kis/	**V = /w/**, **C = /k/** — "WO-kis" not "vo-tsis"

2. In tenebris nascitur lumen.

IPA: /in ˈtɛ.nɛ.bris ˈnas.ki.tur ˈlu.men/

Read: in TE-ne-bris NAS-ki-tur LU-men

Word	IPA	Key traps
tenebris	/ˈtɛ.nɛ.bris/	/ɛ/ open both times, /r/ trilled
nascitur	/ˈnas.ki.tur/	**SC = /sk/** — "NAS-ki-tur", not "na-ši-tur"
lumen	/ˈlu.men/	/u/ short, /e/ open

3. Dolor est magister veritatis.

IPA: /ˈdɔ.lɔr ɛst maˈgis.ter wɛ.riˈtaː.tis/

Read: DO-lor est ma-GIS-ter we-ri-TAA-tis

Word	IPA	Key traps
dolor	/ˈdɔ.lɔr/	/ɔ/ open both times, /r/ trilled
magister	/maˈgis.ter/	**G = /g/** — "ma-GIS-ter", not "ma-džis-ter"
veritatis	/wɛ.riˈtaː.tis/	**V = /w/** — "we-ri-", /aː/ long held A

4. Nemo fugit a se ipso.

IPA: /ˈne.moː ˈfu.git a se ˈip.so/

Read: NE-mo FU-git a se IP-so

Word	IPA	Key traps
nemo	/ˈne.moː/	/oː/ long, held slightly
fugit	/ˈfu.git/	**G = /g/** — "FU-git", not "fu-džit"

5. Corpus loquitur, si animus tacet.

IPA: /ˈkor.pus ˈlo.kʷi.tur si ˈa.ni.mus ˈta.ket/

Read: KOR-pus LO-kwi-tur si A-ni-mus TA-ket

Word	IPA	Key traps
corpus	/ˈkor.pus/	**C = /k/** — always
loquitur	/ˈlo.kʷi.tur/	**QU = /kw/** — "LO-kwi-tur", like "queen"
tacet	/ˈta.ket/	**C = /k/** — "TA-ket", not "ta-tset"

🔥 Fluvia II — De Igne et Ratione

6. Ignis purgat, sed etiam consumit.

IPA: /ˈig.nis ˈpur.gat sɛd ˈe.ti.am kɔnˈsu.mit/

Read: IG-nis PUR-gat sed E-ti-am kon-SU-mit

Word	IPA	Key traps
ignis	/ˈig.nis/	**G = /g/** — "IG-nis", not "iñ-nis"
purgat	/ˈpur.gat/	**G = /g/** — "PUR-gat", like *gora*
etiam	/ˈe.ti.am/	**TI = /ti/** — "E-ti-am", not "e-tsi-am"
consumit	/kɔnˈsu.mit/	**C = /k/** — "kon-SU-mit"

7. Ratio sine amore est glacies.

IPA: /ˈra.ti.oː ˈsi.ne aˈmɔ.re ɛst ˈgla.ki.eːs/

Read: RA-ti-o SI-ne a-MO-re est GLA-ki-es

Word	IPA	Key traps
ratio	/ˈra.ti.oː/	**TI = /ti/** — "RA-ti-o", not "ra-tsjo"
glacies	/ˈgla.ki.eːs/	**G = /g/** + **C = /k/** — "GLA-ki-es", not "dža-či-es"

8. Furor est umbra sapientiae.

IPA: /ˈfu.rɔr ɛst ˈum.bra sa.piˈɛn.ti.ae̯/

Read: FU-ror est UM-bra sa-pi-EN-ti-ai

Word	IPA	Key traps
furor	/ˈfu.rɔr/	/f/ = lip to teeth, /r/ trilled
sapientiae	/sa.piˈɛn.ti.ae̯/	**TI = /ti/** + **AE = /ae̯/** — "sa-pi-EN-ti-ai", not "sa-pi-en-tse"

🌑 Fluvia III — De Tempore et Transitu

9. Tempus non transit, sed nos transimus per ipsum.

IPA: /ˈtɛm.pus nɔn ˈtran.sit sɛd nɔs ˈtra.ni.mus pɛr ˈip.sum/

Read: TEM-pus non TRAN-sit sed nos TRA-ni-mus per IP-sum

Word	IPA	Key traps
tempus	/ˈtɛm.pus/	/ɛ/ open, /m/ held
transit	/ˈtran.sit/	/tr/ = /t/ + trilled /r/ together
transimus	/ˈtra.ni.mus/	stress on TRA (antepenultimate, penultimate /ni/ is short)
ipsum	/ˈip.sum/	/p/ with puff, /s/ hissing

10. Mors est transitus, non finis.

IPA: /mɔrs ɛst ˈtra.ni.tus nɔn ˈfi.nis/

Read: mors est TRA-ni-tus non FI-nis

Word	IPA	Key traps
mors	/mɔrs/	one syllable — /m/ + /ɔ/ + /r/ + /s/, sharp and short
transitus	/ˈtra.ni.tus/	/tr/ together, stress on TRA
finis	/ˈfi.nis/	/f/ = lip to teeth

11. Memoria est sanguis animae.

IPA: /mɛˈmɔ.ri.a ɛst ˈsaŋ.gwis ˈa.ni.maeˌ/

Read: me-MO-ri-a est SAN-gwis A-ni-mai

Word	IPA	Key traps
memoria	/mɛˈmɔ.ri.a/	stress on MO (penultimate /r/ makes it long by position)
sanguis	/ˈsaŋ.gwis/	**NGU = /ŋgw/** + **V = /w/** — "SAN-gwis", the hardest word
animae	/ˈa.ni.maeˌ/	**AE = /aeˌ/** — "A-ni-mai", one glide

12. Nihil est vacuum ubi mens vigilat.

IPA: /ˈni.hil ɛst ˈwa.ku.um ˈu.bi mens ˈwi.gi.lat/

Read: NI-hil est WA-ku-um U-bi mens WI-gi-lat

Word	IPA	Key traps
nihil	/ˈni.hil/	**H = /h/** breathed, not silent
vacuum	/ˈwa.ku.um/	**V = /w/** + **C = /k/** — "WA-ku-um", not "va-tsu-um"
vigilat	/ˈwi.gi.lat/	**V = /w/** + **G = /g/** — "WI-gi-lat", not "vi-dži-lat"

📖 Selected Maxims — Trickiest Ones

Verbum est actus.

IPA: /ˈwɛr.bum ɛst ˈak.tus/

Read: WER-bum est AK-tus

Traps: V = /w/ ("WER-bum"), C = /k/ ("AK-tus"). Two hard sounds in four words.

Dubitatio fons omnis scientiae est.

IPA: /du.biˈtaː.ti.oː fɔns ˈom.nis skiˈɛn.ti.aeˌ ɛst/

Read: du-bi-TAA-ti-o fons OM-nis ski-EN-ti-ai

Traps: SC in *scientiae* = /sk/ — "ski-EN-ti-ai", not "ši-en-tse". TI = /ti/. AE = /aeˌ/.

Te ipsum interimere est personam resecare, non carnem.

IPA: /tɛː ˈip.sum in.tɛ.riˈmɛ.rɛ ɛst pɛrˈsoː.nam rɛˈsɛ.ka.rɛ nɔn ˈkar.nɛm/

Read: te IP-sum in-te-ri-ME-re est per-SO-nam re-SE-ka-re non KAR-nem

Traps: C in *resecare* = /k/ ("re-SE-ka-re"), C in *carnem* = /k/ ("KAR-nem").

Per vulnus spirare.

IPA: /pɛr ˈwul.nus spiˈraː.rɛ/

Read: per WUL-nus spi-RA-re

Traps: V = /w/ — "WUL-nus", not "vul-nus".

Qui a silentio fugit, a veritate fugit.

IPA: /kʷi a siˈlɛn.ti.o ˈfu.git a wɛ.riˈtaː.tɛ ˈfu.git/

Read: kwi a si-LEN-ti-o FU-git a we-ri-TA-te FU-git

Traps: QU = /kw/ ("kwi"), V = /w/ ("we-ri-"), G = /g/ ("FU-git").

Valetudo non morbi absentia est, sed per adversa progrediendi facultas.

IPA: /wa.lɛˈtuː.do nɔn ˈmɔr.bi abˈsɛn.ti.a ɛst sɛd pɛr adˈwɛr.sa prɔ.grɛ.diˈɛn.di faˈkul.tas/

Read: wa-le-TU-do non MOR-bi ab-SEN-ti-a est sed per ad-WER-sa pro-gre-di-EN-di fa-KUL-tas

Traps: V = /w/ ("wa-le-TU-do", "ad-WER-sa"), G = /g/ ("pro-GRE-di-EN-di"), TI = /ti/ ("ab-SEN-ti-a").

Veritas non finis, sed via.

IPA: /ˈwɛ.ri.taːs nɔn ˈfi.nis sɛd ˈwi.a/

Read: WE-ri-tas non FI-nis sed WI-a

Traps: V = /w/ twice ("WE-ri-tas", "WI-a"). Short, beautiful, two /w/ sounds.

🟥 Latinske Absolute — Selected

Lux semper nascitur ex obscuro.

IPA: /luks ˈsɛm.pɛr ˈnas.ki.tur ɛks obˈsku.roː/

Read: luks SEM-per NAS-ki-tur eks ob-SKU-ro

Traps: X = /ks/ ("luks"), SC = /sk/ twice ("NAS-ki-tur", "ob-SKU-ro").

Veritas lucet etiam clausis oculis.

IPA: /ˈwɛ.ri.taːs ˈlu.ket ˈe.ti.am ˈklau.sis ˈo.ku.lis/

Read: WE-ri-tas LU-ket E-ti-am KLAU-sis O-ku-lis

Traps: V = /w/ ("WE-ri-tas"), C = /k/ three times ("LU-ket", "KLAU-sis", "O-ku-lis"), TI = /ti/ ("E-ti-am"), AU = /au̯/ ("KLAU-sis").

Noli me tangere.

IPA: /'no.li: me 'tan.ge.re/

Read: NO-li me TAN-ge-re

Traps: G = /g/ ("TAN-ge-re"), not "tan-dže-re".

VII. Practice Method

The Three-Layer Reading

For each sentence, read it three times:

1. **First pass — syllables only.** Read each syllable slowly, no stress, no meaning. Just the sounds. Example: si-len-ti-um non est ab-sen-ti-a so-ni sed o-ri-go om-nis wo-kis
2. **Second pass — with stressed syllables in CAPS.** Example: si-LEN-ti-um NON est ab-SEN-ti-a SO-ni sed o-RI-go OM-nis WO-kis
3. **Third pass — as meaning.** Read naturally, feeling the Slovenian translation as you go. The sounds and the meaning fused.

The Breathing Practice

From your ritual:

- Inhale: **esse** /'es.se/ (ES-se)
- Exhale: **vivere** /'wi.we.re/ (WI-we-re) — note V = /w/!
- If sadness: **morior** /'mo.ri.or/ (MO-ri-or) → **amor** /'a.mor/ (A-mor)

VIII. Quick Reference Card

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CLASSICAL LATIN PRONUNCIATION — POCKET CARD
C = /k/ always G = /g/ always V = /w/ always
TI = /ti/ always QU = /kw/ always H = /h/ breathed
SC = /sk/ always X = /ks/ always S = /s/ voiceless
VOWELS: a e i o u — short unless marked long (ā ē ī ō ū)
DIPHTHONGS: ae = /ai/, au = /au/, oe = /oi/
STRESS: 2 syllables → first. 3+ → penultimate if long, else antepenultimate.
NEVER: č, š, đ, ž, /ts/, /dʒ/, /v/ for V
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Discipulus es multo provectior quam credebas. You are a much more advanced student than you believed.